FLOATTICKER

Product Requirements Document

Product concept
A Windows desktop app for displaying sponsor logos and messages in a movable, always-on-top ticker over event content or on a dedicated projector display.

Document scope
MVP scope, functional requirements, user workflow, acceptance criteria, and post-MVP enhancements.

Purpose

Give event organizers a simple way to manage sponsor branding during live events, presentations, sports tournaments, cultural festivals, DJ nights, and conferences—without interrupting the content on screen.

Product principle

Separate the control dashboard from the display window. Operators manage sponsors in one window while the ticker runs independently on the event screen or projector.

Working name: FloatTicker | Target platform: Windows desktop | Version: 1.0 requirements draft

1. Product Overview

A floating sponsor ticker for event screens, presentations, scoreboards, and projector output.

Primary users

- Event organizers and production teams.
- Sports tournament operators and scoreboard staff.
- Conference and presentation operators.
- Cultural festival, DJ, karaoke, and live-show teams.

Core user need

Display sponsor logos and accompanying text in a continuously animated ticker, place it where needed, and adjust it live while other applications remain visible and usable.

Key operating modes

Mode	Expected behavior
Desktop overlay	A borderless, optionally transparent window stays above other desktop applications and can be moved and resized.
Projector / second display	The ticker can be placed on a selected monitor or projector, independently from the control dashboard.

Important distinction

An always-on-top overlay and a dedicated projector output are related but different behaviors. The MVP should support a floating desktop overlay first, with basic selection of the target display if feasible. More advanced multi-screen output and scene control can be added later.

2. MVP — Minimum Viable Product

The first release should prioritize reliable live display and straightforward sponsor management.

MVP functional requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
MVP-01	Create a separate ticker display window and a control dashboard.	Must
MVP-02	Keep the display window always on top; support borderless window mode.	Must
MVP-03	Move and resize the ticker window with the mouse; provide a lock-position option.	Must
MVP-04	Add, edit, reorder, enable/disable, and delete sponsor entries.	Must
MVP-05	Upload a sponsor logo from local storage (PNG, JPG/JPEG, WebP; SVG if safely supported).	Must
MVP-06	Set a sponsor name and optional text/tagline; allow logo-only, text-only, or logo-plus-text entries.	Must
MVP-07	Scroll continuously from left to right or right to left.	Must
MVP-08	Adjust scrolling speed while the ticker is running.	Must
MVP-09	Set basic appearance: ticker height, font size, text/logo spacing, text color, background color, and transparency.	Must
MVP-10	Provide Start, Pause, Resume, Stop, Show/Hide, and Restart controls.	Must
MVP-11	Save and reload sponsor lists and display settings locally.	Must
MVP-12	Preview the ticker before displaying it live.	Should
MVP-13	Choose the target monitor from available displays, where technically practical.	Should

MVP user workflow

- Open FloatTicker and create or load an event sponsor list.
- Add each sponsor’s logo, name, and optional tagline or message.
- Reorder the sponsor list and disable entries that should not appear.
- Choose ticker direction, speed, size, colors, and background transparency.
- Preview the ticker, then start the live display.
- Move or resize the ticker over the desired screen area, or select the intended monitor.
- Make live changes without restarting the whole application.

3. MVP Acceptance Criteria

The MVP is considered ready when the following scenarios pass on the target Windows environment.

Area	Acceptance criterion
Window behavior	The ticker remains above normal application windows when enabled as always-on-top. It can be moved and resized without closing the dashboard.
Sponsor data	A user can add at least 20 sponsor entries, edit them, reorder them, and remove or disable an entry.
Media	Uploaded logos display without distortion and fit within the configured ticker height.
Ticker motion	The ticker loops smoothly in both horizontal directions without obvious gaps or sudden jumps under normal operating conditions.
Live controls	Changing speed, direction, visibility, and sponsor order takes effect without restarting the app.
Persistence	After closing and reopening the app, saved sponsor entries and settings are retained.
Safety / usability	A clearly accessible hide action immediately removes the ticker from view.
Projector use	The operator can identify the target display and position the ticker for the event setup, subject to supported Windows display APIs.

Non-functional requirements for MVP

- Performance: smooth scrolling at typical event-screen sizes; avoid unnecessary CPU usage when hidden or stopped.
- Reliability: keep the display responsive while the operator edits sponsor content.
- Usability: core controls should be understandable without technical knowledge.
- Offline operation: the core ticker and local sponsor library should work without internet access.
- Data safety: validate image files and handle missing or unreadable logo files gracefully.

4. Enhancements — Post-MVP Roadmap

Add advanced animation, automation, multi-display capabilities, and remote operation after the core ticker is stable.

Phase	Enhancement	Value
Phase 2	Vertical scrolling: bottom-to-top and top-to-bottom.	Supports more layouts and narrow display areas.
Phase 2	Animation presets: fade, slide, bounce, sponsor transitions, and entry/exit effects.	More polished and varied sponsor presentation.
Phase 2	Individual sponsor duration, pause time, and display frequency.	Provides finer control over sponsor exposure.
Phase 2	Event profiles and reusable presets for different events.	Speeds up setup for recurring events.
Phase 2	Multiple independent tickers with separate content, direction, speed, and position.	Supports simultaneous sponsor strips or announcements.
Phase 2	Advanced styling: gradients, borders, shadows, rounded corners, and custom typography.	Enables brand-aligned layouts.
Phase 3	Remote control from a phone, tablet, or another computer on the same network.	Lets staff operate the display away from the control PC.
Phase 3	Scheduled sponsor playlists and start/end times.	Automates sponsor rotation during an event.
Phase 3	Premium sponsor weighting and priority rotation.	Gives headline sponsors more exposure.
Phase 3	Dedicated transparent output for OBS or compatible streaming software.	Makes sponsor content available to livestream production.
Phase 3	Advanced multi-monitor layouts, per-display profiles, and fullscreen output.	Supports complex venue and LED-wall setups.
Phase 3	Hotkeys, emergency hide shortcut, and operator mode.	Improves control during live events.
Phase 3	Sponsor click-through or QR codes where appropriate.	Adds optional interaction for displays that support it.
Phase 3	Usage logs and basic sponsor exposure reports.	Helps organizers review what was scheduled or displayed.

Enhancement guidance

Prioritize features based on real event workflows. Do not delay the MVP for remote control, scheduling, streaming integration, reporting, or complex animation. First prove that the ticker is stable, legible, easy to position, and simple to control live.

5. Suggested Technical Approach

A practical implementation direction for a Windows-first desktop product.

Component	Recommendation
Desktop runtime	Electron with React, TypeScript, and Vite.
Window management	Electron BrowserWindow options for always-on-top, frameless, transparent, resizable, and target-display positioning.
Ticker rendering	HTML/CSS-based rendering with CSS animations; keep the ticker display isolated from dashboard UI updates.
State management	Zustand or equivalent lightweight state store for live configuration.
Persistence	Local JSON for a small MVP; SQLite if structured data and future reporting are expected.
Assets	Store logo files locally and persist references; validate file type and handle missing files.
Packaging	Windows installer with a clear app shortcut and a simple update strategy.

Implementation notes

- The dashboard and ticker renderer should be separate windows so editing controls do not appear in the public display.
- Use a clear configuration model for sponsors, for example: id, name, logoPath, text, enabled, order, and optional style settings.
- Keep the renderer lightweight; avoid re-rendering the entire sponsor strip on every animation frame.
- Test always-on-top behavior with presentation software, browsers, media players, and multi-monitor configurations.
- Transparent windows and projector routing can vary by OS/window manager; validate the exact Windows version and display setup during development.

Suggested sponsor data fields

Field	Purpose
id	Unique sponsor identifier.
name	Sponsor or organization name.
logoPath	Local path to the logo asset; optional for text-only sponsors.
text	Optional tagline, offer, or message.
enabled	Whether the sponsor appears in the rotation.
order	Position in the sponsor sequence.
style	Optional per-sponsor sizing, colors, or text emphasis; advanced styling can be deferred.

6. Out of Scope for the MVP & Open Decisions

Explicitly out of scope for the first release

- Cloud accounts, team collaboration, and cloud synchronization.
- Remote operation over the internet.
- Automated sponsor billing, analytics, or proof-of-play reporting.
- Complex video backgrounds or full motion-graphics authoring.
- Guaranteed overlay behavior over protected fullscreen video or exclusive fullscreen applications.
- Native integrations with every presentation, scoreboard, or streaming platform.

Decisions to confirm before implementation

Decision	Recommended starting point
Operating system	Windows 11 first; validate Windows 10 only if required.
Window mode	Floating overlay as the primary MVP mode; basic target-monitor selection if feasible.
Ticker direction	Horizontal, both directions in MVP; vertical scrolling in Phase 2.
Animation	Continuous marquee in MVP; additional effects in Phase 2.
Sponsor content	Logo plus optional title/message; local files and offline operation.
Display control	One ticker in MVP; multiple independent tickers later.
Branding	Provide a default theme and a small set of editable colors; advanced brand presets later.

Definition of MVP success
An event operator can create a sponsor list, configure a horizontal ticker, position it over the event display, adjust it live, hide it instantly, and reopen the app later with the same saved setup.